

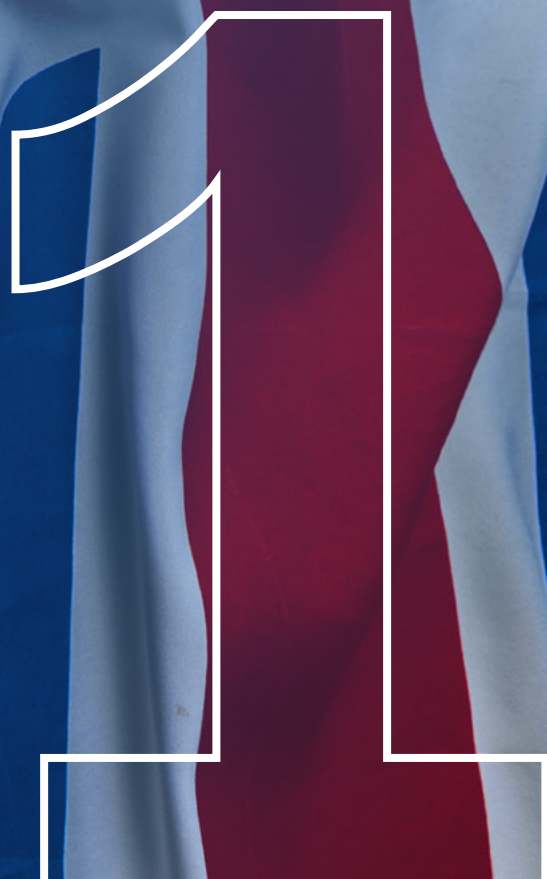
# Unit 1

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## Living in the Present

Inglés Profesional





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# Introduction

In this unit, we will start with the basics to build a strong foundation in English. First, we will study the verb **to be** and the verb **to have got** in the present tense, looking at their structure, uses, and special rules. Then, we will learn about the **present simple**, focusing on how to form it, when to use it, and the **adverbs of frequency** that go with it. After that, we will move on to the **present continuous**, examining its structure, key uses, and the rules for forming **-ing verbs**, including spelling changes. To finish the unit, we will talk about the **stative verbs** and compare the **present simple** and the **present continuous**, explaining their differences and when to use each one in different situations.



# 1.1

## The verb "To Be"

### 1.1.1. Definition and Uses

The verb **to be** is one of the most important verbs in English. It is used to:

- > Describe people, things, weather or situations
  - » Example: She **is** a teacher.
- > Give information about age, nationality, profession, etc.
  - » Example: I **am** Spanish. / He **is** 25 years old.
- > Talk about locations
  - » Example: They **are** at home.
- > Talk about feelings and states
  - » Example: We **are** happy today.
- > Form continuous tenses (See present continuous)
  - » Example: She **is** studying English.

### 1.1.2. Forms of "To Be" in the Present Tense

The verb **to be** is irregular, meaning it **does not follow the regular rules** of other verbs.

| Affirmative | Negative     | Interrogative |
|-------------|--------------|---------------|
| I am        | I am not     | Am I?         |
| You are     | You are not  | Are you?      |
| He is       | He is not    | Is he?        |
| She is      | She is not   | Is she?       |
| It is       | It is not    | Is it?        |
| We are      | We are not   | Are we?       |
| You are     | You are not  | Are you?      |
| They are    | They are not | Are they?     |





Additionally, in spoken and informal written English, **to be** is often contracted.

### Contractions (Short Form)

| Affirmative | Short Form | Negative     | Short Form                |
|-------------|------------|--------------|---------------------------|
| I am        | I'm        | I am not     | I'm not                   |
| You are     | You're     | You are not  | You're not / You aren't   |
| He is       | He's       | He is not    | He's not / He isn't       |
| She is      | She's      | She is not   | She's not / She isn't     |
| It is       | It's       | It is not    | It's not / It isn't       |
| We are      | We're      | We are not   | We're not / We aren't     |
| You are     | You're     | You are not  | You're not / You aren't   |
| They are    | They're    | They are not | They're not / They aren't |

### Examples:

- » I **am** a student. (= I'm a student.)
- » You **are** my friend. (= You're my friend.)
- » She **is not** a doctor. (= She **isn't** a doctor.)
- » We **are not** in the park. (= We **aren't** in the park.)
- » **Are** they happy?
- » **Is** he at school?

### Short answers

Short answers must include the verb **to be** instead of just "yes" or "no."

| Question            | Affirmative Answer | Negative Answer  |
|---------------------|--------------------|------------------|
| Are you a student?  | Yes, I am.         | No, I'm not.     |
| Is he your brother? | Yes, he is.        | No, he isn't.    |
| Are they at school? | Yes, they are.     | No, they aren't. |

### 1.1.3. Summary Table

| Sentence Type | Structure                            | Example                           |
|---------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Affirmative   | Subject + am/is/are                  | "She is a teacher."               |
| Negative      | Subject + am/is/are + not            | "She is not a teacher."           |
| Question      | Am/Is/Are + subject?                 | "Is she a teacher?"               |
| Short Answer  | Yes/No + subject + am/is/are (+ not) | "Yes, she is." / "No, she isn't." |



# 1.2.

## "To Have Got" vs. "To Have"

### 1.2.1. Meaning and Uses

Both **have got** and **have** are used to express:

- > **Possession (something you own)**
  - » Example:  
"I **have got** a new phone" or "I **have** a new phone"
- > **Relationships (family, friends, etc.)**
  - » Example:  
"She **has got** two brothers" or "She **has** two brothers."
- > **Physical Appearance**
  - » Example: "He **has got** blue eyes" or "He **has** blue eyes."
- > **Illnesses or Conditions**
  - » Example:  
"They **have got** a headache" or "They **have** a headache"

#### BUT

- > **Have got** is more common in **British English**.
- > **Have** is used in both **American** and **British English**.

So, in the **UK**, people often say "**I've got a car**", but in the **US**, people usually say "**I have a car**".

### 1.2.2. Forms of "To Have Got" and "To Have" in the Present Tense

| Affirmative               | Negative                           | Interrogative                        |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| I have got / I have       | I haven't got / I don't have       | Have I got...? / Do I have...?       |
| You have got / You have   | You haven't got / You don't have   | Have you got...? / Do you have...?   |
| He has got / He has       | He hasn't got / He doesn't have    | Has he got...? / Does he have...?    |
| She has got / She has     | She hasn't got / She doesn't have  | Has she got...? / Does she have...?  |
| It has got / It has       | It hasn't got / It doesn't have    | Has it got...? / Does it have...?    |
| We have got / We have     | We haven't got / We don't have     | Have we got...? / Do we have...?     |
| You have got / You have   | You haven't got / You don't have   | Have you got...? / Do you have...?   |
| They have got / They have | They haven't got / They don't have | Have they got...? / Do they have...? |



### Contractions (Short Form)

| Have Got                                              | Have                                |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Have got / has got = 've got / 's got                 | Have / has = no contraction         |
| Have not got / has not got = haven't got / hasn't got | Do not / does not = don't / doesn't |

#### > Examples:

- » I **have got** a pet. (= I've got a pet.)
- » She **has got** two brothers. (= She's got two brothers.)
- » They **have not got** a big house. (= They **haven't got** a big house.)
- » He **has not got** a car. (= He **hasn't got** a car.)
- » You **have** green eyes. (✗ You've green eyes.)
- » The dog **does not have** a tail. (= The dog **doesn't have** a tail.)

### Short answers

#### > Examples:

- » **Have** you **got** a car? → **Yes, I have.** / **No, I haven't.**
- » **Has** she **got** a brother? → **Yes, she has.** / **No, she hasn't.**
- » **Do** they **have** a child? → **Yes, they do.** / **No, they don't.**
- » **Does** he **have** a motorbike? → **Yes, he does.** / **No, he doesn't.**

### 1.2.3. When NOT to Use "Have got"

**Have got** is only used in the **present**.

You **CANNOT** use "**have got**" in **past**, **future**, or **continuous tenses**.

- > ✓ I **had** a bike **when** I **was** a child. (Correct)  
(See the past in Unit 3)
- > ✗ I **had got** a bike **when** I **was** a child. (Wrong)
- > ✓ She **will have** a big house **in the future**. (Correct)  
(See the future in Unit 4)
- > ✗ She **will have got** a big house **in the future**. (Wrong)
- > ✓ He **is having** lunch. (Correct)  
(See the present continuous below)
- > ✗ He **is having got** lunch. (Wrong)



### 1.2.4. Summary Table

| Sentence Type | "Have Got" / "Have"                                   |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Affirmative   | I have got a car / I have a car                       |
| Negative      | I haven't got a car / I don't have a car              |
| Interrogative | Have you got a car? / Do you have a car?              |
| Short Answer  | Yes, I have / No, I haven't / Yes, I do / No, I don't |



#### RECUERDA

"Have got" solo se utiliza en inglés británico.

Este verbo solo se usa en presente simple.

Para los demás tiempos verbales (presente continuo, pasado, futuro) usamos el "have", que funciona como cualquier otro verbo.





# 1.3.

## Present Simple

### 1.3.1. Definition and Uses

The **Present Simple** is a verb tense used to describe:

- > **Habits and Routines** → Actions that happen regularly  
» Example: "I **wake up** at 7 AM every day."
- > **General Truths and Facts** → Things that are always true.  
» Example: "Water **boils** at 100°C."
- > **Permanent Situations** → Things that do not change over time.  
» Example: "She **lives** in Madrid."
- > **Scheduled Events (Timetables)** → Used for fixed events in the future. (See 'The future' in Unit 4)  
» Example: "The train **leaves** at 8 PM."
- > **Feelings and Opinions** → Used with stative verbs (like, love, believe, know, etc.).  
» Example: "I **like** chocolate."

### 1.3.2. How to Form the Present Simple

| Affirmative | Negative         | Interrogative  |
|-------------|------------------|----------------|
| I work      | I don't work     | Do I work?     |
| You work    | You don't work   | Do you work?   |
| He works    | He doesn't work  | Does he work?  |
| She works   | She doesn't work | Does she work? |
| It works    | It doesn't work  | Does it work?  |
| We work     | We don't work    | Do we work?    |
| You work    | You don't work   | Do you work?   |
| They work   | They don't work  | Do they work?  |

#### > Examples:

- » I **play** football every weekend.
- » She **plays** tennis on Saturdays.
- » He **watches** football at the weekend.
- » You **don't like** coffee
- » They **don't go** to the gym.
- » **Do you like** pizza?
- » **Does** she **speak** English?

#### > Short Answers:

- » **Do you like** coffee? → ✓ **Yes, I do.** / ✗ Yes, I like.
- » **Does she play** football? → ✓ **No, she doesn't.**

#### 💡 RECUERDA

En las oraciones negativas e interrogativas, el verbo principal permanece en su forma base:

- + ✗ He doesn't works.
- + ✓ He doesn't work.

- + ✗ Does she speaks English?
- + ✓ Does she speak English?

"Do not" se puede contraer como "don't" y "does not" como "doesn't."



### 1.3.3. Spelling Rules for Third-Person Singular (He/She/It)

- > We add **-s** to most verbs:
  - » "He **works** in a bank." / "It **rains** a lot in the UK."
- > We add **-es** to verbs ending in **-ch, -sh, -x, -ss, -o**:
  - » "She **watches** TV." / "He **goes** to school."
- > We add **-s** to verbs ending in **vowel + y**:
  - » "Jane **plays** the piano"
- > With verbs ending in a **consonant + y**, we change **y** to **i** and add **-es**:
  - » "Charles **studies** English." / "Anne **tries** her best."



#### RECUERDA

- + En la mayoría de los verbos, añadimos **-s**:
  - > get → gets / like → likes / see → sees
- + En los verbos terminados en **-ch, -sh, -x, -ss, -o**, añadimos **-es**:
  - > watch → watches / go → goes / smash → smashes
- + En los verbos terminados en vocal + **y**, añadimos **-s**:
  - > play → plays / say → says / enjoy → enjoys
- + En los verbos que terminan en consonante + **y**, cambiamos la **"y"** por **"i"** y añadimos **-es**:
  - > study → studies / cry → cries / try → tries

### 1.3.4. Adverbs of frequency

Adverbs of frequency tell **how often** something happens.

#### A- Common Adverbs of Frequency (from most to least frequent)

| Adverb      | Meaning        | Example                                                  |
|-------------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Always      | Siempre        | "She <b>always</b> arrives early."                       |
| Often       | A menudo       | "He <b>often</b> goes to the gym."                       |
| Frequently  | Frecuentemente | "She <b>frequently</b> travels for work."                |
| Usually     | Usualmente     | "I <b>usually</b> drink coffee in the morning."          |
| Generally   | Generalmente   | "People <b>generally</b> prefer warm weather over cold." |
| Normally    | Normalmente    | "I <b>normally</b> wake up at 7 a.m."                    |
| Sometimes   | A veces        | "We <b>sometimes</b> watch movies at night."             |
| Rarely      | Raramente      | "They <b>rarely</b> eat fast food."                      |
| Hardly ever | Casi nunca     | "We <b>hardly ever</b> drink alcohol."                   |
| Never       | Nunca          | "I <b>never</b> smoke."                                  |



## B- Word Order: Where to Place the Adverb?

### 1. Before the main verb

- ✓ I **always** eat breakfast.
- ✓ She **never** watches TV.
- ✗ I study **always** in the evening.

### 2. After the verb 'to be'

- ✓ He is **always** late.
- ✓ They are **never** tired.
- ✗ He **usually** is late.

### 3. Between an auxiliary verb and a main verb

- ✓ I don't **usually** eat sweets.
- ✓ They don't **always** arrive on time.
- ✗ I **usually** don't eat sweets.

## C- Exceptions and Special Cases

### 1. "Sometimes" and "Usually" can also go at the beginning or end of a sentence:

- ✓ **Sometimes**, I go for a walk.
- ✓ I go for a walk **sometimes**.

### 2. "Never" is already negative, so don't use "don't" or "doesn't" with it:

- ✓ He **never** eats meat.
- ✗ He doesn't **never** eat meat. (Incorrect!)

## D. Adverbs of Frequency with "Very" and Other Modifiers

When **adverbs of frequency** are modified by words like "**very**" or "**too**", they can go at the **end of the sentence**.

- ✓ She doesn't eat sweets **very often**.
- ✓ He goes to the gym **too rarely**.
- ✓ We visit our grandparents **quite frequently**.

## RECUERDA

Los adverbios de frecuencia se colocan delante del verbo principal, después del verbo 'to be' o entre un auxiliar y un verbo principal:

- + ✗ I eat always fruits
- + ✓ I always eat fruits
- + ✗ He always is late
- + ✓ He is always late
- + ✗ He usually doesn't drink coffee
- + ✓ He doesn't usually drink coffee.

Algunos adverbios de frecuencia como "sometimes" y "usually" pueden ir también al principio o al final de la oración.

Cuando los adverbios de frecuencia van acompañados de palabras como 'very' o 'too', pueden ir al final de la oración.

## 1.3.5. Summary Table

| Sentence Type | Structure                                 | Example                                             |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Affirmative   | Subject + base verb (+s/es for he/she/it) | "She plays football."                               |
| Negative      | Subject + do/does + not + base verb       | "He doesn't like coffee."                           |
| Interrogative | Do/Does + subject + base verb?            | "Do you study English?"                             |
| With adverbs  | Adverb + verb OR to be + adverb           | "They often go to the park." / "He is always late." |



# 1.4.

## Present Continuous

### 1.4.1. Meaning and Uses

The **Present Continuous** tense is used to describe actions that are happening **right now** or around the **current time**, or to talk about **future plans**. Common adverbs used with this tense are **now**, **at the moment**, **currently**, **today**, **this week**, etc.

#### Uses

- > **Actions happening at the moment of speaking**
  - » *Example:* She **is reading** a book **right now**.
- > **Temporary actions** (things happening around the present, but not necessarily at the exact moment of speaking)
  - » *Example:* I **am studying** English **this year**.
- > **Future arrangements or plans** (fixed plans for the near future) (*See 'The future' in Unit 4*)
  - » *Example:* We **are meeting** them **tomorrow**.

### 1.4.2. How to Form the Present Continuous

| Affirmative       | Negative             | Interrogative      |
|-------------------|----------------------|--------------------|
| I am studying     | I am not studying    | Am I studying?     |
| You are studying  | You aren't studying  | Are you studying?  |
| He is studying    | He isn't studying    | Is he studying?    |
| She is studying   | She isn't studying   | Is she studying?   |
| It is studying    | It isn't studying    | Is it studying?    |
| We are studying   | We aren't studying   | Are we studying?   |
| You are studying  | You aren't studying  | Are you studying?  |
| They are studying | They aren't studying | Are they studying? |

#### Examples:

- > I **am eating** lunch.
- > She **is watching** TV.
- > They **aren't playing** football.
- > You **aren't swimming** right now.
- > **Are you studying** English.
- > **Is she dancing**?

#### Short Answers

- > "Is he **working** today?" → **Yes, he is.** / **No, he isn't.**
- > "Are they **going** to the party tonight?" → **Yes, they are.** / **No, they aren't.**



### 1.4.3. Spelling Rules for Verbs with -ing

When forming the **Present Continuous**, you add **"-ing"** to the verb. However, there are a few rules to follow:

1. **Verbs ending in -e:** Remove the **-e** and add **-ing**:
  - » *Make* → **Making**
  - » *Dance* → **Dancing**
  - » *Write* → **Writing**
2. **Verbs ending in a single consonant after a vowel:**  
Double the consonant and add **-ing**:
  - » *Run* → **Running**
  - » *Sit* → **Sitting**
  - » *Swim* → **Swimming**
3. **Verbs ending in -ie:** Change **-ie** to **-y** and add **-ing**:
  - » *Die* → **Dying**
  - » *Lie* → **Lying**

### 1.4.4. Summary Table

| Sentence Type | Structure                            | Example                          |
|---------------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Affirmative   | Subject + am/are/is + verb-ing       | "He is playing."                 |
| Negative      | Subject + am/are/is + not + verb-ing | "He is not playing."             |
| Interrogative | Am/are/is + subject + verb-ing?      | "Is he playing?"                 |
| Short Answer  | Yes/No + subject + am/is/are (+not)  | "Yes, he is." / "No, he is not." |

#### 💡 RECUERDA

El Presente Continuo se usa para **acciones que están ocurriendo ahora o alrededor del presente.**

**NO se usa para acciones habituales** (para eso se usa el Presente Simple).

**Algunos adverbios comunes con este tiempo verbal:** now (ahora), at the moment (en este momento), currently (actualmente), today (hoy), this week (esta semana), etc.





# 1.5.

## Present Simple and Present Continuous

### 1.5.1. Stative verbs

**Stative verbs** are verbs that describe **states, not actions**. They usually refer to **emotions, thoughts, possession, the senses, and relationships**. These verbs are **NOT** normally used in the **Present Continuous** because they describe something that is not changing or in progress.

#### Types of Stative Verbs

##### 1. Verbs of emotion and feeling

» like, love, hate, prefer, need, want

- + ✓ I **like** pizza.
- + ✗ *I am liking pizza.*
- + ✓ She **wants** a new phone.
- + ✗ *She is wanting a new phone.*

##### 2. Verbs of thinking and opinion

» believe, think, know, understand, remember, forget

- + ✓ I **believe** in ghosts.
- + ✗ *I am believing in ghosts.*
- + ✓ I **know** the answer.
- + ✗ *I am knowing the answer.*

##### 3. Verbs of senses (how something seems or feels)

» see, hear, smell, taste, feel, look

- + ✓ This cake **tastes** delicious.
- + ✗ *This cake is tasting delicious.*
- + ✓ I **hear** music.
- + ✗ *I am hearing music.*

##### 4. Verbs of possession and being

» have, own, belong, be

- + ✓ He **has** a big house.
- + ✗ *He is having a big house.*
- + ✓ This book **belongs** to me.
- + ✗ *This book is belonging to me.*



## Exceptions

Some verbs can be **stative** or **action verbs**, depending on the meaning:

### > Think

- » ✓ I **think** this is a good idea. (= I **believe** → **stative**)
- » ✓ I **am thinking** about my future. (= I **am considering** → **action**)

### > See

- » ✓ I **see** a bird. (= I **notice it** → **stative**)
- » ✓ I **am seeing** my friends later. (= I **am meeting them** → **action**) (See the Future in Unit 4)

### > Have

- » ✓ I **have** a car. (= **possession** → **stative**)
- » ✓ I **am having** lunch. (= **eating** → **action**)

## 1.5.2. Comparative table between the Present Simple and Present Continuous

Here's a **comparative table** between the **Present Simple** and the **Present Continuous**, highlighting their key differences in **use**, **structure**, and **examples**.

| Aspect                  | Present Simple                                                 | Present Continuous                                      |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Main Use                | Habitual actions, routines, and general facts.                 | Actions happening right now or around the current time. |
| Affirmative Structure   | Subject + base verb (+s for he/she/it)                         | Subject + am/are/is + verb-ing                          |
| Affirmative Example     | She works in a bank.                                           | She is working late today.                              |
| Negative Structure      | Subject + do/does not + base verb                              | Subject + am/are/is + not + verb-ing                    |
| Negative Example        | They don't like coffee.                                        | They are not drinking coffee.                           |
| Interrogative Structure | Do/Does + subject + base verb + ?                              | Am/Are/Is + subject + verb-ing + ?                      |
| Interrogative Example   | Do you speak English?                                          | Are you speaking English right now?                     |
| Key Words               | Always, usually, often, sometimes, never, every day/week/year. | Now, at the moment, currently, today, this week.        |



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